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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

I wanted to analyse how Emily Bronte portrayed women in her work, being a woman herself. I am very interested in feminist issues in the world today, and I thought this could be particularly interesting because Bronte and her sisters published their work when it was very unusual for women to write and they used male pseudonyms, which could mean that she conveyed feminist views in her work. Additionally, I believe the topic is worth investigating since it is still globally relevant.

By communicating with my supervisor I learned how to plan and reflect on my work better, which also made me alter my research question by asking “To what extent . . ?” rather than asking a yes or no question. I believe that was a really good decision since it did not limit the options I had for my conclusion. This will help me in future studies, to ask open-ended questions that do not limit the investigation. I was surprised to see how critical Bronte’s writing actually is, after learning more about the social constructs of her time. I added a hypothesis by trying to prove the author was a proto-feminist, which helped me to focus the research a lot better.

The secondary research process made my vision for the essay even clearer since at first I was not aware of how many great feminist interpretations there are that have been made about Wuthering Heights. Although the novel was definitely the main focus and primary source for the essay, I managed to find a lot of additional sources that helped me support my argument about Bronte having feminist views. They mainly helped me display how society was structured during the time the novel was written. I learned about the early concepts of feminism which led to what it is today. The most challenging part of the writing and research process was applying the topics that the author wrote about in the 19th century to today’s world. I believe this helped me learn how to connect the historical context to the modern world and distinguish between change and progress.

Through the process of researching and writing this essay, I have also learned practical skills which will help me in my future studies at university. I have learned how to do research, how to find reliable academic sources, how to plan, draft and edit a formal essay – and how to meet deadlines. I am very satisfied with my work although I believe that my connection of the research to today’s society could have been a bit clearer.

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